

PSYCHIC INTERACTION OF NEGATIVITY

Greetings and blessings for every one of my beloved friends here. The power of love and the strength of truth will unfold in you forever more as you grow on your path.

In our last lecture of this working season I would like to say to you, first of all, that the overall work that has been accomplished in this past year by the group as a whole is extremely important and significant. This will become particularly clear when this lecture will be thoroughly understood and assimilated. The majority of you have learned to be connected with, to be aware of, and to admit quite a lot of negativity, negative intentionality. Some have done more than others in this realm, but everyone is on the way.

The significance and value of this progress cannot even be perceived as yet. It makes a lot of difference whether you are aware of negative intentionality or whether you blindly grope, act out, and consequently suffer a special kind of confusion that is more painful than real pain. The benefit of this new state of awareness is equally great for yourself and for others. In this lecture I would like to show you what the unconscious psychic interaction between you and others means in terms of love and in terms of the pain of guilt we talked about in the last lecture.

When you are only vaguely aware of your negativity, when you only dimly sense the hurt that it inflicts on others, and when you therefore are caught in a battle between blame, self-justification, self-victimizing, helplessness, self-rejection, and self-doubt, you cannot help but hook others with their own unconscious problems and conflicts into your negativity. You bind them in a struggle equal to the one I just described.

Many of you have already started to recognize that by denying your negativity, you incur a double guilt. First, there is the guilt for the negative attitude in question. This we may call the primary guilt. Then you are involved in the guilt for denying this negativity, which we may call the secondary guilt. The primary guilt, if it were admitted and the consequences of it truly accepted, would cease to be a guilt. The secondary guilt must weigh heavily on everyone's soul. It is a burden that consumes much of vital life energy. Your denial must always imply harmful acts (inner and/or outer) toward others. It is always insult added to injury and may therefore truly be called a sin. It is a sin because you punish others for your own failings, for your very own negative intentions, lovelessness, untruthfulness, spite, and your unfair demands.

If you are aware, for instance, of the fact that you do not wish to love and you do not pretend otherwise, this is your responsibility. If you realize that you pay a heavy price for a loveless existence, but you let it go at that, at least you do not hook others into your guilt for not loving. You will be alone and isolated, of course, but you have made a choice. You know it and you pay the

price for it. You withhold from the world your wonderful love capacity, that is true, and in that sense you fail.

But when you blame others for your lack of love, even if you use their real shortcomings as your excuse; when you punish them for the result of your own unloving attitude; when you build cases in order to justify your own holding back; then you truly sin, my friends.

This process is most widespread, most common, and yet so subtle that only people who possess a considerable amount of self-awareness begin to recognize it in themselves and therefore also in others. It is a basic attitude. It exists in variations and with varying degrees of intensity. The refusal to love, when not admitted, often manifests in the following attitude: "I do not want to give you anything (whoever "you" may be) but I demand that you give me everything. If you do not, I will punish you." This is very typical. The more concealed and the less consciously expressed, the more insidious its effect on the self and others. It is always relatively easy to deny, rationalize, distort, conceal, or use half-truths to justify this attitude.

Several of my friends have lately been able to see in themselves and admit this attitude not only to themselves but also to their friends in the group. The influx of health, of the clean fresh air of psychic truth is instant. It is a result of freeing yourself of the secondary guilt. The more you expose every detail of the disparity between your demands, your own unloving intentions, and the punishment you mete out when the demands are not being met, the more you clear yourself of guilt. The clearer you can see the preposterous unfairness of what you demand compared to what you give, how differently you insist to be treated as compared to how you threaten others, and in what particular way you choose to punish -- but always so that you cannot be caught, so that you cannot be made accountable -- the quicker you will free yourself of a burden which causes depression, anxiety, worry, hopelessness, and often physical illness and material frustration as well.

One of the most popular ways of punishing others for not responding with love to your unlovingness is to render them guilty, to build the case in such a way that they seem to be the cause for your misery. You convince yourself quite successfully of this because you choose to see only the result of your withholding and spiteful and/or cowardly non-giving. You choose to ignore that others cannot respond the way you would like when your own psyche is still steeped in this negative attitude toward life.

Your negativity says, "I will deny the truth and will blame you for not giving me all and for not letting me get away with my one-sided demands. And if you dare to react to this, I will punish you by hating you and by blaming you even more." Those who are at the beginning of their path or those who have a very strong investment in their idealized self image that makes no room for this truth will first think it is quite impossible that they, too, can harbor such an attitude. Your best gauge to determine whether or not it exists and to what extent it exists is to consult your state of mind and emotions. If you feel secure, unafraid, at ease, comfortable with others, without anxiety, if you expand your life in a joyous way, and if you regard occasional difficulties as meaningful stepping stones, then it is true that you have already vastly overcome this poisonous attitude. But you, too, must have had it and must have dealt with it in a truthful way. No one is entirely free from it at birth. If you have not found this attitude, you must work your way through your pride, your investment in your pretense, your cowardice.

When you admit your negative intentionality, you perform the most fundamental act of love. The moment you admit what you are doing, you are committing an act of love, my friends, whether you know it or not. If you do not admit it, you may give a lot, but never the real thing that counts most. You may give things, money, aid, good deeds, altruistic actions; you can even give tenderness and concern, but they are hollow gifts without the one gift of setting the other free by the honest admission of your negativity.

The guilt caused by your unfair demands, your spite, the withholding of your love, and then the compounded guilt caused by punishing others for your misery must erode your strength and your self-expression. It makes you truly weak. How can you, as long as you continue in this attitude, ever have faith in yourself, ever believe in your dignity as a free human being? You may try all sorts of artificial ways to instill self-confidence into yourself, but it will never work unless you face the secondary guilt and give it up by admitting it. Then you may even stay, if you so choose, with the primary guilt -- the guilt of not wanting to love. But at least assume the responsibility.

You see, my friends, this is a world of duality. So much confusion exists because of the either/or alternative -- in almost any area. I often discussed this topic, in connection with several issues. The topic under discussion is particularly prone to the confusion arising out of a dualistic approach to life. Man is stymied by the concept that either he is to be blamed (for whatever it may be) or the other person is to be blamed. Either he is bad and wrong or the other person is. This creates a terrible predicament. It makes it impossible to be in truth. If you are wrong and the other person blameless, you feel somewhere that there is something not quite right about it. You feel also, in this distortion, that an undue responsibility is placed on you. If it is either/or, and you are the one to assume the sole burden of the blame, you surely expect to be ostracized. This assumption is an unbearable load. It is untruthful and does not permit you to be in clarity. It makes you feel even more inferior and unlovable. Your misery seems a just punishment, and not a result of a chosen attitude you are free to alter whenever you so decide. By assuming the sole blame, you give permission, as it were, to the other person to secretly act out his own negative intentionality.

Or, conversely, if you have to be completely right and justified in explaining your behavior, then also you get yourself into a terrible predicament. You again feel that there is something wrong. That the other is all bad does not fit either. If you have to protect this pretense which may seem desirable in order to whitewash yourself from guilt, you must become anxious, afraid, tense, threatened of having your defenses penetrated -- so you cannot afford to be relaxed, natural, and close to others. Your stake at being "innocent" prevents intimacy. Again you cannot feel right.

Most human beings are as yet incapable of experiencing how one's distortion and negativity directly plays into, affects, reinforces, and hooks into the distortions and negativities of others. They are still too involved in the dualistic struggle, in their own defense and protection of their illusory self-image. Therefore they are blind to the psychic reality of constant interaction between self and others. The "either self or the other" creates a terrible predicament of confusion, of guilt, and of self-doubt.

In the inner interaction from psyche to psyche, the following takes place. Suppose you inwardly say: "I will punish you for not fulfilling my insatiable demands. I will not love you or give you anything. I will punish you by making you guilty, and if you want something from me, I will not give it to you. I punish you most effectively by making myself the victim, so you cannot blame or

catch me." Suppose the other person is inwardly struggling with giving up a similar defense, and his resistance says: "You must not. Others are out to hurt, to victimize, to exploit you. If you open your heart to love, you will get nothing but rejection, unfairness, and hate in return. It does not pay. You had better remain closed up." Just imagine how your self-victimizing attitude will reinforce the irrational resistance of the other person to being open, vulnerable, and loving. The frightened part of the self which is geared to the "protective" negativity and withholding will be set back considerably in his struggle whenever he encounters such a negative intentionality. The punishment often takes the form of severe accusations that malign the other's character. You may never have thought about it in these terms, but if you look closely, you will see that it amounts to just that. Or you may even use a real failing of the other person as an excuse to punish him for not living up to your demands and for not accepting a deal from you in which he gives everything and you little or nothing (on that level -- on other levels, the case may be quite different.)

The unconscious interaction in this area thus fortifies, justifies, and increases the conviction of the necessity of negativity as a defense. Viewed from this narrow vantage point, the position seems right. Thus, when you pursue your negative intentionality, you are also responsible for the other. It is one of the apparent paradoxical truths of spiritual reality that you are responsible for yourself and you are also responsible for the other, each in a different way. By the same token, the other person's negative intentionality hurts, impairs, and hinders you, and he is responsible for doing this to you. Yet, he could not succeed if you would not tenaciously hold on to your own. And in that way, it is your responsibility. Everyone has the choice of either letting the other's bad intentions be an excuse to stay in his own or else looking for a new way of responding to life. Thus it is equally true to say that you are exclusively responsible for yourself; others are exclusively responsible for themselves; and also, that everyone is also responsible for the other.

Since ultimately there is no division between the self and the other, both must be true. You are the others and the others are you. The separation is as much an illusion as it is an illusion that you are in the struggle of the either/or duality. Again, it is not that either you are responsible for yourself or for the other or that the other is responsible either for himself or for you. It is all true. It is all the same.

Therefore, when you come out from the old pattern of blaming others in order to justify your unfairness and your unloving demands, you not only unhook yourself from this terrible bind and double-bind, you also help unhook the other person. Of course the other should not depend on you. He must fend for himself and find his own salvation. You may say, "Others should not depend on my overcoming my negativities and problems so that they can overcome theirs." And you are both right and wrong. You are right that it is indeed the other's responsibility and that he can do so no matter what you do, provided he really wants to. His effort, his investment, his commitment to himself determine the outcome regardless of what others, including you, do. But you are also wrong in not seeing that by your act of truth, which is an act of love, you help set the other free in his entanglement and struggle to find out where is he to blame and where you are to blame. When you make it clear what you are doing, you remove a great deal of confusion and doubt so that the true picture can emerge of where and to what extent each part contributes to a negative involvement and psychic interaction. This has a tremendously liberating effect.

There are stages in the human development where an entity finds it almost impossible at a particular phase to come out of his negative defense system, of his involvement with it, and of his

conviction that this defense is necessary; unless someone around him with whom he is involved lets him off the hook by admitting his own negative intentionality, his destructive attitude, his dishonesty, his meanness. Just imagine how you would feel when someone close to you, who has given you pain by pointing out your real and your false guilts, but who has also confused you by denial of his guilt, suddenly said to you: "You know, I do not want to give you love. I want to demand from you and then blame you, accuse you, and punish you when you do not comply with my demands. I do not allow you to be hurt either, because although I want to hurt you, I do not want to be made to feel guilty by your hurt." Just imagine how this sets you free! How this suddenly clears up many confusions. It is not very likely that you would respond to this act of love by being self-righteous and acting the all-innocent one who has always known this and is now established as the innocent victim.

If you admit your similar unfair demands, your cowardice to give your feelings and your negative intentionality, it may indeed be hurtful for your pride, but truly for nothing else! The other who hears it has, in that moment, received a gift of love from you, even though you may still not want to love with your heart, with your feeling, with your inner being. But you have begun to love by being truthful.

By setting the other person free from the false guilt that you have placed on him in order to conceal your own, you allow him to look at his own real guilt without self-devastation and without this most painful of inner struggles in which the mutual guilts and accusation are all confused. This release and clarification often leads to the solution of the deepest problems. It is as though the personality needed this "outer" grace, this helping hand. For the dishonest placing of guilt on the other makes the other's true self-revelation almost impossible because it is implied that if he admits his guilt, you are right in accusing him of being bad and of being the cause of your misery. This is how people are hooked together in denial, guilt-projection, either/or struggle, confusion, and negative interaction. Someone must begin to loosen up the hook-up and release the knots.

Negative intentionality is, as you know, a defense. It stems from the innate belief that the world cannot be trusted and the only way the self can preserve itself from unfair exploitation and harm is by being as mean as the world is supposed to be -- or meaner. When you admit your ill will, you help the other to begin to trust in the decency of the world, in the decency of people. He can then begin to ponder, "Maybe it is not so dangerous after all. Maybe I am not all alone in my hidden shame and guilt. Maybe I can let go. Maybe I, too, can admit and will not be held solely responsible." What a difference in interaction and in attitude toward life, in the total, spiritual position of a human entity!

The energy system must begin to change. When you all work together in this honest way, love is not a command of the will and mind. It is not an abstraction. It is not a sentimental gesture and emoting. It is active vigorous, assertive, and free as is the inherent nature of love whatever form it may take. Honesty is the form of love that is most needed in the interaction of human beings, and that is most rare. Unless this expression of love exists, the illusion will always remain that you and others are separate; that your interests are contradictory; that in order to protect your interests, you must defeat those of others, and vice versa.

Only when you know your own negativity, my friends, truly own up to it, assume responsibility for it, and no longer project it onto others, distorting reality in order to be able to do

so; only then will you suddenly gain new insight into other people's doings so that even when they do not admit it, you will know what is happening. And that too sets you free. That too takes you out of the confusion and the guilt of "What am I doing? What is the other doing? Where am I to blame? Where am I at fault in my misery? How have I caused it? How has the other caused it?" Thus you fluctuate between blame and self blame. Neither road leads to any solution. But the moment you assume responsibility for your negative, destructive attitudes towards others, even if others are not willing to do likewise, you see the picture clearly. You unhook yourself not only by your admission and self-knowledge but, as a consequence, by seeing and comprehending the negative intentions, the negative acting out, the dishonest projections of the other person. And this too sets you free. Then you will be truly independent. This is why everyone who admits the worst in himself inevitably feels elation, liberation, energy, hope, and light as an immediate result.

It is a known fact that spiritual growth brings you the gift of knowing the inside of other people: their thoughts, their intentions, their will direction, their feelings. This is not magic that is bestowed upon you. It is a natural phenomenon that occurs because in reality you and others are one. As you read your own mind accurately, you cannot help reading those of others since it is really all one mind. The depths of the other person's mind, that was previously a closed book, is only a closed book as long as your own depth is something you hide and run away from. It would be a magical and dangerous thing to be able to read others' minds and inner being if this ability were a result of psychic power. Then it could be abused. But whenever this ability grows organically as a by-product of knowing your own inner makeup, it is a natural phenomenon and cannot be abused in the service of power drives and negativity.

What now seems like a separated entity altogether will be seen for what it is in undifferentiated reality, when truthfulness in the sense discussed here has been realized. It will be seen that all is one -- that there is only one consciousness. What a liberating experience to know and to see into others and to no longer be confused and torn! This ability grows from giving up your stake in hiding, projecting, denying, and distorting. It grows from giving up an attitude which not only confuses others around you who are in a similar state but with which you confuse yourself every bit as much.

We discussed in the last lecture the pain of guilt. The worst pain of guilt is the one where you do not quite know what is your part and what is the other's part. This kind of suffering comes only from concealment. It tears you apart. In this suffering you search blindly. You are like a trapped animal. But you are your own victim. You have trapped yourself by choosing not to be honest, by avoiding honesty.

Whenever a human being is unfolding into a more expanded state, he needs different tools, different modes of operation. Let us take the simple analogy of someone who conducts a business. When the business is still very small, he has an organization that is adapted to this particular size. This kind of organization is meaningful for the purpose and scope of the firm. It is appropriate and therefore harmonious. But when the business is expanded into a larger concern, the type of organization he has created for the previously small establishment no longer fits the larger one. Were he to maintain it, it would no longer be appropriate and could not run smoothly. He would meet with a great deal of obstacles he did not have before. What was once appropriate and meaningful no longer fits. What was once harmonious is, under different circumstances, a cause for disharmony. If the businessman would be too rigid to make changes and would persist in holding

on to the old, proven way, he would either fail in the expanded enterprise, or, at least, he would find it very difficult and arduous to live and work.

The same law, my friends, applies to your inner expansion. As you grow and learn about yourself and therefore about others and the world; as you experience life in deeper and more varied ways (which is, after all, your reason for being incarnated); as you gain understanding; as you learn to experience feelings which you have previously avoided, you are setting up the stage, as it were, for an "expanded operation." In practical terms, this means that attitudes that once were useful now become destructive and limiting.

It happens so often on the path of evolution that entities are growing in various ways and prepare the ground for necessary new attitudes toward life. Yet they impede this expansion by their refusal to give up certain attitudes. So you must prepare yourself for this flexibility and adapt yourself to new ways of responding to the world, my friends; of responding differently to other people's reactions toward you; of responding in a new way to what happens around you and to what happens within you. This will come about, first, by knowing that your old response is a conditioned reflex which was created to fit a smaller way of functioning in life; and, second, by questioning that reflex and the meaning behind it; and, last but not least -- and this is the basic theme of tonight's lecture -- by choosing love rather than separateness as your way of being in the world.

Again, this must not merely be a word. It must not merely be a mental concept, a willful try, or a sentimentalized emoting that covers up many things you do not wish to admit. It must be put in action wherever you inwardly are. Admitting your negativity is always an act of love whether it is done directly to the person in question, where this is possible, or to a helper who is not personally involved with your negativity. It is still an act of love toward the universe. Wherever you find your negativity, my friends, even while you still choose to keep with it, contemplate that one day you will want to give it up in love for the universe, in love for yourself.

Love is the key. If you do not open your heart, you must wither away. You have all seen that no matter how true something may be; how right something is; how intelligent your analyses are; how many insights you have into the background, the history, and the dynamics of a condition that gives trouble; unless you commit yourself to opening your heart, no real change can ever occur. You cannot be fulfilled, my friends, unless you let yourself feel from the heart. And it is no use pretending that you want to love, that you even do love, as long as you are frightened of feeling your feelings. To the degree that is so, you hold back from loving.

You cannot be strong and courageous, you cannot love yourself unless you love. It is equally true that only as you love others can you love yourself. The first step must be to be willing to love. You do not start loving simply because you so choose. You have to call the divine nature of your innermost nucleus to give you the grace of loving. The grace of God may manifest through you in making you open your heart and lose your fear of feelings, of being vulnerable. That is all you need. If you do not love, you have nothing. If you love, you have everything.

But if you love falsely as a pretense, it is much, much less loving and much more deceptive and harmful than when you admit your hate. Admitting your hate is more loving than an apparently loving act that denies the hate. Think of this, my friends.

May the few months, in which you have time to assimilate the material I have given and during which you are without this direct contact here, help you to more and more establish the most real and most vital of all direct communications -- that with your spiritual self. But in order to do so, you must eliminate your self-deceptions and pretenses. They always block the way to God in you.

Those of you who have not yet found where and how they are unloving should set out to do so. Do not let yourself be deceived by where you are already loving. Ask yourself how fulfilled you feel in it; how warm and unthreatened you feel with others; how comfortable do you feel in life? That is your answer to how loving and how truthful you are. And then maybe the first step of love can be instituted: admit your hate. Admit your punitiveness. Admit your spitefulness. To the degree you do so, you start loving. You have started on the bottom rung of the ladder of love the minute you admit the ugly truth that you wanted hidden and for which, on top of it, you rendered the other person responsible. You did this by either totally distorting reality or by using something that was partially true as your excuse.

To understand this, my friends, requires a lot of meditation and genuine good will. But then, what a key this is to life! You must deeply want to see this. You will then also gain the understanding of how tremendously significant this working year has been for this group, for the majority of the people in it. For everyone has, at least to some degree, made a little bit of such an admission. The more you resist expansion into a new state of operation when you are ready for it, the greater and more painful the necessary crisis must be. The more volitional and unresisting, the smoother the transition into a new, more truthful, more loving state will be.

Now commit yourself to go further and deeper in this direction. Commit yourself to go all the way with it and thereby help yourself and those around you. Allow this to happen. It is the greatest blessing that can be. You thus create the necessary new climate for a new inner environment -- inside and outside.

This was a blessed working year indeed, my friends. Many of you have manifested their spiritual growth in visible expressions of a more fulfilled life, of more peace and security, and of outer fulfillment as a result. The following years will become more so, as you expand this nucleus of spiritual learning and purification. You are indeed blessed. Every step of truth, every step toward love unleashes more spiritual energy. Every step of decency activates more of your divine nature. Be this divine nature!

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